

HIGH SCHOOL BASKETBALL

Saints sock it to Ridgeville

Erich Burnett
The Chronicle-Telegram

LORAIN — December yielded little more than hard-luck losses for North Ridgeville, with Friday's game at Southview still another defeat, but with a different scenario.

It wasn't hard luck, just an old-fashioned beating as the Rangers flubbed their way to a 70-45 loss to the host Saints, their sixth straight after a 2-1 start to the season.

"This has not been a trend," said Rangers coach Dan Rademaker, whose team slipped to 2-7 (0-3 Erie Shore Conference). "We have not played bad basketball, but tonight we played as badly as you could possibly play."

"I don't know what happened. Southview came out and played good defense, we stood around and they took it to us. We got a good old-fashioned whoopin' tonight."

Things started well enough for the Rangers, as Brad Thompson opened the game with a 3-pointer from the top of the key. Southview followed with 14 of the next 16 points, however, quickly turning the game into a transitional track meet.

The Saints (3-4, 1-1) outscored Ridgeville 16-7 in the first quarter while claiming a 12-3 rebounding advantage, and also forced six turnovers while committing just two of their own.

"We didn't respond in any phase of the game," Rademaker said.

An 11-0 Southview run to open the second quarter didn't help matters, as six steals helped build a 37-14 bulge at the half.

"The defense dominated the tempo," Southview coach Larry Stark said. "We're not a run-and-gun team by any means. That's not really our style, though we like to pick and choose."

The worst news for the Rang-

NR	G	F	T	Southview	G	F	T
D Lume	2	1	5	Ortiz	1	0	3
Reynolds	0	0	0	Olivencia	3	0	6
Elkins	0	0	0	Wargo	6	0	14
Soto	4	0	6	Hughes	4	0	9
Casper	1	1	4	Mizwell	4	1	11
Daniels	1	1	4	Thames	2	1	5
Jackson	0	2	2	Sanford	1	2	4
Thompson	2	0	5	Lane	2	1	5
S Lima	4	4	13	Ball	0	0	0
Vannol	1	0	2	Moon	3	1	7
McCostlin	0	0	0	Schulz	3	0	6
Totals	15	12	45	Totals	25	6	75

Points by Quarters	1	2	3	4	T
Ridgeville	7	7	18	15	45
Southview	16	21	16	17	70

ers came when high-scoring senior Kevin Jackson went down in a heap as time expired in the second quarter.

Jackson remained on the floor as his team retreated to the locker room, and was aided off the court several minutes later, not to return. Rademaker speculated after the game that Jackson's injury was likely a sprain.

Ridgeville showed signs of life in the second half, scoring seven of the first 10 points before Southview responded with a 9-0 run for a 49-21 lead. Senior Gary Maxwell sparked the Saints, scoring all 11 of his points in the third and fourth quarters, including 3-pointers to open both periods.

"Gary's a good perimeter shooter and he can take it to the hole," Stark said. "We can shoot the ball. If the shots are open, we'll take them, but we've got to be more selective."

Selective or not, the Rangers were still unable to get closer than 53-28 after Southview's third quarter spurt. For the game, the Saints outrebounded Ridgeville 28 to 19, forced 22 Ranger turnovers and stole the ball nine times.

"The kids have really played good defense the last few games and throughout this game," Stark said. "It's been a strong point all year."



TOM MAHL/CHRONICLE

LOOKING FOR MORE: Southview's Larry Sanford (32) looks upcourt as teammate Floyd Lane fills the lane in the Saints' 70-45 win over North Ridgeville.

Chad Wargo carried the weight for Southview early, scoring 11 of his game-high 14 points in the first half. Scott Lime led Ridgeville with 13 points, followed by Ryan Sgro with eight.

"We just did not respond to their pressure," Rademaker said. "We got into no continuity on offense, which we really needed to do. It was one-on-one for much

of the first half, and we're not a one-on-one team. We've got to make passes and run our offense, and we just didn't do it."

Southview gets back into action tonight, traveling to city rival Admiral King in another Erie Shore game. The Rangers are idle until early next year, hosting Sandusky in a conference game next Saturday, Jan. 4.

ROUNDUP

Olmsted Falls suffers first loss

SANDUSKY — Olmsted Falls suffered its first loss of the season, 58-53, to Erie (Pa.) Cathedral Prep in the first round of the Streakball Classic Friday.

Tim Schaefer scored 29 points for Olmsted Falls but the Bulldogs (6-1) couldn't overcome a nine-point half-time deficit.

Erie	G	F	T	OlmFalls	G	F	T
Florini	7	2	18	Storey	3	0	7
Ganier	1	3	6	Williams	1	1	4
Straub	4	5	19	Radigan	1	2	4
Whitson	5	4	14	Kalenka	1	2	6
Bianus	3	1	7	Schaefer	13	2	29
				Knaus	1	0	2
				Perkins	0	1	1
Totals	26	17	58	Totals	21	8	53

Three-point goals: Erie: Florini 2, Ganier 2, Olmsted Falls: Storey, Radigan, Schaefer. Junior Varsity: No game.

Copley.....78
Avon Lake.....62

COPLEY — Avon Lake ran to an early lead but couldn't keep up the pace, losing to Copley in the first round of the First Merit Classic Friday.

A 14-0 run by Copley in the third quarter turned the game around.

AvonLake	G	F	T	Copley	G	F	T
Balogh	9	0	22	Harne	14	2	30
Hille	8	2	14	Kozicki	6	3	13
Strauch	3	0	9	Dochat	6	1	13
Daniels	3	1	8	Schaffer	2	2	7
Luznar	2	1	5	Ward	3	0	6
Welch	2	0	4	White	3	0	6
				Zolton	1	0	2
Totals	25	4	62	Totals	34	9	78

Three-point goals: Avon Lake: Balogh 4, Strauch 3, Daniels, Copley, Schaffer. Junior Varsity: No game.

Medina.....70
Westlake.....43

WESTLAKE — Medina had too much firepower for West-

lake, topping the Demons in a non-conference game Friday.

Medina	G	F	T	Westlake	G	F	T
Pap	5	6	16	Petrovic	1	0	2
Crider	1	0	2	Giuliano	1	0	2
Hodge	8	2	19	Yaman	5	3	17
Scott	0	0	0	Pell	2	0	5
Trapp	3	0	6	Fischer	2	1	5
Kase	4	2	10	Hukstetter	0	0	0
Chase	3	2	8	Armstrong	2	0	5
Miler	0	0	0	Diamond	1	0	3
Ebner	0	0	0	Machuca	0	1	1
Petrala	1	2	4	Inch	1	0	2
Slavik	0	2	2	Ferns	0	0	0
Lee	1	1	3	Jones	0	0	0
Totals	26	17	70	Totals	15	5	43

Three-point goals: Medina: Hodge. Westlake: Yaman 4, Armstrong, Diamond. Junior Varsity: Westlake 34-44.

Berea.....81
Mercyhurst (Pa.).....79

MERCYHURST, Pa. — Berea's Jon Carroll and Tom Sieker hit clutch baskets to force the game into two overtimes and the Braves went on to beat Mercyhurst (Pa.) in the first round of the Mercyhurst holiday tournament Friday.

Carroll hit a layup with two seconds left in the fourth quarter to force the first overtime and Sieker hit a three-point shot to send the game into a second overtime.

The Braves will face Girard, Pa., in tonight's championship game. Girard beat H.B. Beal of Ontario, Canada, 52-38 in Friday's other preliminary game.

Berea	G	F	T	Mercy	G	F	T
Burke	2	2	6	Vincent	2	0	5
Sieker	3	0	6	Verga	12	8	22
Mey	2	0	8	Rzepicki	2	0	6
Cook	5	5	11	Colman	2	0	6
Roan	3	3	16	Turce	5	0	2
Carroll	5	7	20	Kozik	5	2	11
Sieker	1	0	2	Rosa	2	2	6
Lake	0	0	0				
Rivera	6	0	12				
Totals	35	15	61	Totals	28	18	79

Three-point goals: B — Sieker 2, May 2, Carroll 2, M — Vincent, Verga 2, Rzepicki 2.

North Olmsted dumps Twinsburg

Scott Petrak
The Chronicle-Telegram

CLEVELAND — North Olmsted coach Tim Schmotzer knew his team would leave the ninth annual North Coast Christmas Holiday Classic with valuable game experience against quality competition.

After Thursday's 68-46 loss to Glenview, Schmotzer just didn't know if the Eagles would leave Cleveland State's Woodling Gymnasium with a win. But the Eagles recovered from the loss and health problems to defeat Twinsburg Chamberlin, 64-50, in the consolation game Friday.

In the championship, Glen-

Twinsburg	G	F	T	NOlmsted	G	F	T
Hendon	3	2	8	Meczka	6	2	14
Wallace	2	0	4	Corny	0	0	0
Bel	4	1	12	Lazada	0	0	0
Williams	2	2	6	Kovelan	6	0	12
Basel	0	0	0	Sulzer	2	2	5
Kimble	1	0	2	Husak	2	2	3
Fitzgerald	1	0	2	Jane	1	0	3
Miller	2	0	4	Ryan	1	0	0
Driller	1	1	2	Grodek	1	1	3
Enkley	0	0	0				
Miller	0	0	0				
Gurley	2	0	4				
Totals	18	11	50	Totals	24	12	64

Points by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 T
Twinsburg 9 13 12 16 — 50
N Olmsted 13 17 10 18 — 64

Three-point goals: Twinsburg: Bet 3, North Olmsted: Lazada 2, Husak 2. Junior Varsity: No game.

ville rallied to beat Shaker Heights, 73-71, in overtime.

Controlling the tempo with numerous passes on offense, the

Eagles (4-5) turned the game into a halfcourt contest, the direct opposite of Thursday's fullcourt, fast-paced game.

With Twinsburg (4-4) visibly uncomfortable, North Olmsted scorched the nets, shooting 59 percent from the floor.

"We shot such a high percentage because we were moving the ball and setting screens, which is our philosophy," Schmotzer said. "We got a lot of open looks at the basket."

The Tigers, a step slow all night, looked just as agitated when they were on offense, missing several inside shots early, and finishing 18-for-51 for 35 percent.

"I was disappointed in us that we allowed them to play that tempo," Twinsburg coach Bob Pacsi said. "They dragged us into a methodical tempo. And we were standing around."

Senior guard Angel Lazada and senior center/forward James Kovelan led the torrid Eagles' shooting in the first half. Lazada was 4-for-4 including a 3-pointer for 10 points, and Kovelan was 4-for-4 for eight points and five rebounds as North Olmsted took a 30-22 lead at halftime.

A 3-pointer by Twinsburg's David Bet cut the margin to 32-25 with 6:30 left in the third quarter, but the Tigers never got closer than nine the rest of the game.

The Tigers looked poised to make a run at the start of the fourth quarter when two Lawrence Fitzgerald free throws cut the deficit to 46-36. But the Eagles ended any Tiger hopes with a free throw and drive by Tom Sulzer, a freshman player by Mike Husak and a putback by Gerard Meczka that made the score 53-36 with 4:48 remaining.

"It was a good win," Schmotzer said. "We've been going through some adversity with illnesses and a guy down (Ryan Wingenfeld with back spasms)."

"The kids have been rising to it. That's what life's all about." Meczka led all scorers with 14 points, and grabbed eight rebounds. Lazada, 13, Kovelan, 12 points and eight boards, and Husak, 10 points, also reached double-figures for the Eagles.

Bet paced the Tigers with 12, including three 3-pointers.

"There is no doubt (playing in the tourney) was good experience," Schmotzer said. "Playing Glenview and Twinsburg will help us in the tournament and the league."

EC

From D1

"The kids gave it a valiant effort, but turnovers just killed us," said Lias. "We just went through some periods where we tried to force some things we shouldn't have."

Padua outscored Elyria Catholic 19-6 in the second period as the Panthers got into foul trouble. The 6-foot-6 Behne and the 6-4 Wilhelm both went to the bench with over six minutes left in the frame, each with their second foul. Sophomore point guard R.C. Clapham, likewise, joined his two mates after getting his second foul with 5:11 left in the first half.

With three of EC's starters on the bench, the Bruins pushed a 23-14 lead to a 29-16 advantage by halftime.

With the size difference equalized, Padua took advantage of EC's bench as it converted nine of 10 free throws the first half. The Panthers, meanwhile, never visited the line until 4:36 remained in the third quarter.

"I think Padua played good defense, but I think we shot ourselves in the foot, too," said Lias.

"Last week, we only had 15 turnovers against Notre Dame/Cathedral Latin."

Behne led EC with 16 points while Wilhelm and Mack each added 10. Padua's Pat Friery paced all scorers with 17.

"We just let them back in the game the third period," said Padua coach Dave May. "Then we had to struggle the rest of the way."

In the junior playoff game, Padua (1-5, 1-3 NCL) outscored Elyria Catholic (3-3, 2-2 NCL) 18-6 in the last nine minutes to chalk up a 31-28 win. The visitors were held scoreless for almost seven minutes in the second half. Kyle Neff led the Panthers with six.

PLAYERS	G	F	PA	FT	F	P
Padua	14	7	5	3	4	17
Behne	1	1	8	5	3	10
Wilhelm	1	1	5	2	3	8
Clapham	1	1	2	2	2	6
Behne	1	1	2	1	0	3
Slaby	1	1	2	1	0	3
John Tens	1	1	0	0	1	2
Totals	58	18	27	19	17	58

PLAYERS	G	F	PA	FT	F	P
Elyria Catholic	12	7	3	2	4	16
Behne	12	4	2	1	3	19
Wilhelm	10	4	1	0	4	9
Slaby	3	2	0	0	0	4
Clapham	3	1	0	0	4	2
Behne	1	0	0	0	3	0
Slaby	1	0	0	0	0	0
Kellen Olson	1	0	0	0	0	0
Totals	52	21	16	8	21	51

Score by Quarters: 1 2 3 4 OT OT T
Padua 11 15 10 22 — 58
Three-Point Goals: Elyria Catholic (1-10) Wilhelm 1-1, Behne 0-1, Clapham 0-2, Mack 0-2, Mellich 0-4, Padua (1-9) Capone 1-4, Slaby 0-1, Owens 0-1, Link 0-1, Friery 0-2. Junior Varsity: Padua 31-28.

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